



The queen begins building the nest until her first babies are big enough, after which they take over.

The wasps chew and chew dead wood until it becomes pulpy. It then dries into paper.

Nests

Wasps either live alone (solitary wasps) or in large groups (social wasps). Those that live together build large nests made out of dead wood that they chew into paper.

Bees and wasps have powerful biting mouthparts.



Common wasp

Wasps

There are many different families of wasps. Most adults have a narrow waist between their second and third segments, and large eyes.

Stings

Wasps and bees have yellow and black stripes that warn people they are venomous. They only sting when they feel threatened or they are defending their home.



Living alone

Many wasps do not live in groups, but prefer to live alone. They are called solitary wasps. They are mostly parasitic, laying their eggs on other insects.

Ichneumon wasp (solitary)



Moving in swarms

When a new queen is born, she will leave with a group of wasps to build and rule her own nest. The wasps all fly off together in a group called a swarm. In this picture they are resting.

True, they can only sting once.